My First Beacon

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 14

The invitation lay open beside the completed lantern. It asked for one steady light and one short chime to mark the community gathering. Nib looked from the working fittings to the waiting meeting place. Every small repair had helped make this final signal possible.

“My first beacon,” Nib whispered proudly. “Our neighbors’ useful light,” Lark added warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **shut**

“At the ends of my, by, and fly, y can say long i,” Lark modeled clearly. “That is a different job from y at the start of yes. Read these whole words, then revisit lift, shut, and tap on our prepared instruction strip.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try my, by, fly. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the agreed signal instructions,” Lark invited warmly. “Which job opens the light, and how many chimes does the invitation ask for?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I can fly by a pine. My ring is in a box.**

“Where is the ring?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence tells us, rather than telling us about flying?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib used the prepared handle while the shade lifted. Steady light reached the aligned window. One short chime followed. At the meeting place, a flag waved in reply. The signal had reached its intended readers and listeners. After the gathering, the borrowed guide returned to its keeper. A brass star badge and an ordinary viewing lens joined the explorer kit.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write my beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark bound The Long Path and carried it home to the library. The fixed lantern stayed useful on Lookout Hill. A separate Storyboat invitation arrived with returning visitors. The hill adventure was complete before a new voyage began.